

RITUAL FOUNDATIONS

# Petition Papers & Written Will

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Clarity, prayer, consent, and the disciplined act of naming

SHRINE OF THE INNER THRONE

A sovereignty-led companion for disciplined, culturally careful practice.

# The Word Becomes Accountable

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A petition turns desire into language, and language reveals whether the desire can withstand ethical examination.

## The Inner Law

Writing slows intention down. A petition can hold a name, condition, prayer, verse, command, promise, or request. In African American Hoodoo, written papers have been used with candles, roots, containers, powders, shoes, Bibles, and many other forms of work. Methods vary, and some belong to particular workers or lineages.

The paper is not powerful because the handwriting is secret. Its first power is precision. It shows what you are asking, who is affected, what you are willing to do, and where your request becomes unclear or coercive.

## A Mirror for the Practitioner

- Can I state the petition without disguising my true motive?
- Does it concern what I can govern?
- What would fulfillment require from me?
- Does the language preserve the dignity and agency of everyone named?
- What practical evidence would show that the condition has changed?

## Prayer and Power

Biblical prayer, especially the Psalms, has a deep historical place in many forms of Black Christian conjure and Hoodoo. Not every practitioner works within the same theology. Use only sacred language you can approach with sincerity and respect. A verse is not a decoration or a spell stripped of its religious life.

# Anatomy of a Clear Petition

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A strong petition is brief enough to remember and specific enough to guide action.

## Five Parts

- Subject: name the person, household, project, or condition truthfully.
- Movement: choose a clear verb - protect, reveal, welcome, release, strengthen, reconcile, complete.
- Ethical boundary: include mutual good, right relationship, or 'without harm or coercion' where appropriate.
- Evidence: name how the result would appear in ordinary life.
- Responsibility: state the action you will take in alignment with the petition.

## Examples

- Unclear: 'Make everything work out.' Clearer: 'May the right information be revealed so I can choose with courage and care.'
- Coercive: 'Make this person return to me.' Sovereign: 'May love that is mutual, honest, and freely chosen find and remain with me.'
- Passive: 'Bring me prosperity.' Accountable: 'May my work be fairly valued, wisely offered, and met by the clients it can truly serve.'

## Names and Privacy

Use another person's full name only when the work is appropriate and ethically defensible. Protect written petitions from casual viewing. Do not photograph or publish private names, health matters, legal issues, or intimate requests for content.

# Form, Fold, and Placement

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Physical choices help organize attention; they are methods, not universal laws.

## Paper

Plain paper is sufficient. Brown paper, torn edges, parchment, or specialized paper may carry historical, practical, or aesthetic meaning, but expense does not increase spiritual authority. Use a writing instrument that is legible and stable.

## Crossing and Turning

Some practitioners write a name a set number of times, turn the paper, and write the desired condition across it. The visual crossing joins subject and aim. If you use this form, choose a number and direction deliberately rather than copying without understanding.

## Folding

Toward may symbolize drawing; away may symbolize release. Inward may conceal or contain. Outward may reveal or send. Record your chosen logic so the gesture remains meaningful.

## Placement

A petition may be kept in a journal, beneath an unlit object, beside a safely held candle, inside a jar, or in another deliberate place. Never place paper where it can ignite. Privacy and fire safety outrank symbolic drama.

# A Petition of Sovereign Alignment

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This practice brings desire, responsibility, and evidence into one written form.

## The Work

1. At the top of a plain paper, write your full name once.
2. Below it, complete this sentence: 'I now strengthen my capacity to...'
3. Name one condition that depends primarily on your choices: speak clearly, complete a project, protect your time, receive fair exchange, or release an expired obligation.
4. Add: 'I recognize this alignment when...' and list two observable signs.
5. Add: 'My next faithful action is...' and name a step you can take within forty-eight hours.
6. Read the petition aloud. Remove any phrase that promises certainty, denies consent, or hides responsibility.
7. Fold the paper toward yourself and keep it in your journal for seven days. Take the action. At the end, annotate the paper with what occurred.

My word and my conduct face the same direction. I ask clearly, act responsibly, and release what is not mine to govern.

## Completion and Disposal

Archive a petition when it contains a lesson worth keeping. Shred or burn only when privacy and safety allow. If burning, use a legal, fire-safe method outdoors or in a proper vessel; extinguish completely. Ordinary recycling or disposal can also be respectful when sensitive information is removed.

# Return to the Inner Throne

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Written will is trustworthy when it can meet truth, consent, and consequence.

## Journal the Practice

- Which word revealed my actual desire?
- What part of the petition was within my authority?
- How did the ethical boundary change the request?
- Did I complete the promised action?
- What evidence appeared in ordinary life?

## Common Missteps

- Writing vague petitions that cannot guide action
- Using another person's name to justify control
- Copying number systems or symbols without context
- Placing paper under a live candle or near flame
- Keeping every petition active indefinitely instead of reviewing and closing it

## Sources for Continued Study

- Yvonne P. Chireau, *Black Magic*.
- Katrina Hazzard-Donald, *Mojo Workin'*.
- Zora Neale Hurston, 'Hoodoo in America.'
- Library of Congress African American folklore and WPA collections, read critically and in historical context.

## Closing

Write what is true. Ask for what preserves dignity. Let your next action  
sign the petition.